

Hazem Ibrahim

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BIO

I study how the technologies people rely on every day shape who gets seen, heard, and valued. A social media feed decides which political voices reach millions of viewers. An AI chatbot answers with political leanings of its own, and those answers can change the mind of the person asking. Academic publishing decides who gets access to science and whose work gets credit. My research measures what these systems actually do. I build software that audits platforms from real devices, run field experiments spanning tens of thousands of interactions, and analyze records covering millions of videos, articles, and scientific papers. I aim to produce clear evidence about how these systems treat people, and practical ways to make them fairer.

EDUCATION

2023–2027 (expected)	Ph.D. , Computer Science, New York University Thesis: <i>Understanding bias, inequality, and human behavior in socio-technical systems.</i> Advisor: Yasir Zaki
2018–2020	M.Sc. , Computer Science, University of Toronto Advisor: Syed Ishtiaque Ahmed
2014–2018	B.Sc. , Computer Engineering, New York University Abu Dhabi

AWARDS & HONORS

2026	Google PhD Fellowship in Human-Computer Interaction
2025	Best Poster Award, AI4GS
2024	Best Parallel Talk Award, IC2S2
2024	Best Poster Award, IC2S2
2023	Innovators Under 35, MIT Technology Review
2018	Founder's Day Award, NYU Abu Dhabi

PUBLICATIONS

* denotes corresponding author; [†] denotes joint first authorship.

Published

- [1] **Ibrahim, H.[†]**, Jang, H. D.[†], Aldahoul, N., Kaufman, A. R., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. Systematic partisan content skews in TikTok during the 2024 U.S. elections. *Nature* (2026).
- [2] Jang, H. D., **Ibrahim, H.**, Asim, R., Varvello, M. & Zaki, Y. A tale of three location trackers: AirTag, SmartTag, and Tile. In *Proc. ACM Internet Measurement Conference* (2026). *Forthcoming*.

- [3] Khan, F. K., **Ibrahim, H.**, AlDahoul, N., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. Who gets seen in the age of AI? Adoption patterns of large language models in scholarly writing and citation outcomes. *Journal of Informetrics* 20, 101869 (2026).
- [4] **Ibrahim, H.**, Khan, F. K., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. Analyzing political stances on Twitter/X in the lead-up to the 2024 U.S. election. *PoliticalNLP Workshop at LREC* (2026).
- [5] **Ibrahim, H.**[†], Liu, F.[†], Zaki, Y. & Rahwan, T. Citation manipulation through citation mills and pre-print servers. *Scientific Reports* 15, 5480 (2025).
- [6] **Ibrahim, H.**, Sabie, D., Roy, P., Bhattacharjee, A., Alam, S. M. R., Mim, N. J. & Ahmed, S. I. Heritage language maintenance: The case of Bangladeshi immigrants in Canada. *Interaction Design and Architecture(s) Journal (IxD&A)*, 170–206 (2025).
- [7] **Ibrahim, H.**, Debicki, M., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. Big tech dominance despite global mistrust. *IEEE Transactions on Computational Social Systems* 11, 3741–3752 (2024).
- [8] **Ibrahim, H.**, AlDahoul, N., Lee, S., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. YouTube’s recommendation algorithm is left-leaning in the United States. *PNAS Nexus* 2, pgad264 (2023).
- [9] **Ibrahim, H.**, Asim, R., Zaffar, F., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. Rethinking homework in the age of artificial intelligence. *IEEE Intelligent Systems* 38, 24–27 (2023).
- [10] **Ibrahim, H.**, Liu, F., Asim, R., Battu, B., Benabderrahmane, S., Alhafni, B., Adnan, W., Alhanai, T., AlShebli, B., Baghdadi, R. et al. Perception, performance, and detectability of conversational artificial intelligence across 32 university courses. *Scientific Reports* 13, 12187 (2023).
- [11] **Ibrahim, H.**, Asim, R., Varvello, M. & Zaki, Y. I tag, you tag, everybody tags! In *Proc. ACM Internet Measurement Conference* (2023), 561–568.
- [12] **Ibrahim, H.** & Ibrahim, W. Gamification in online educational systems. In *6th International Conference on Higher Education Advances (HEAd’20)* (2020), 1217–1224.
- [13] Ibrahim, W. & **Ibrahim, H.** Multithreaded and reconvergent aware algorithms for accurate digital circuits reliability estimation. *IEEE Transactions on Reliability* 68, 514–525 (2018).

Preprints & Under Review

- [14] **Ibrahim, H.**[†], Liu, F.[†], Mengal, K., Alshaibi, W., Kaufman, A. R., Zaki, Y. & Rahwan, T. Causal evidence of racial and institutional biases in accessing paywalled articles and scientific data (2025). *Revise and resubmit at Science*.
- [15] **Ibrahim, H.**, Rahwan, T., Zaki, Y. & Park, M. On-screen inertia: persistent racial and gender disparities in Hollywood film (1900–2024). arXiv:2608.28613 (2026). *Under review at PNAS*.
- [16] **Ibrahim, H.**[†], AlDahoul, N.[†], Abbasi, S. M. A., Zaffar, F., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. A longitudinal analysis of racial and gender bias in New York Times and Fox News images and articles (2025). *Under review at Scientific Reports*.
- [17] Kuo, C. W.[†], Chu, K.[†], AlDahoul, N.[†], **Ibrahim, H.**[†], Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. Neutralizing the narrative: AI-powered debiasing of online news articles (2025). *Revise and resubmit at Engineering Applications of Artificial Intelligence*.
- [18] AlDahoul, N.[†], **Ibrahim, H.**[†], Park, M., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. Inclusive content reduces racial and gender biases, yet non-inclusive content dominates popular media outlets (2025). *Under review at EPJ Data Science*.

- [19] Aldahoul, N., **Ibrahim, H.**, Kaufman, A. R., Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. The political ideology of large language models: measurement, inconsistency, and persuasive influence. arXiv:2505.04171 (2025). *Revise and resubmit at American Political Science Review.*
- [20] **Ibrahim, H.**, et al. Schadenfreude in the digital public sphere: a cross-national and decade-long analysis. arXiv:2601.20413 (2026). *Under review at Journal of Big Data.*
- [21] **Ibrahim, H.*** & Girmay, T. Auditing differential visibility of political content on TikTok. arXiv:2607.17356 (2026). *Under review at ICWSM 2027.*
- [22] **Ibrahim, H.*** & Zaki, Y. Informational help-seeking on Reddit did not decline after ChatGPT. arXiv:2609.12447 (2026). *Under review at ICWSM 2027.*
- [23] **Ibrahim, H.*** & Zaki, Y. Price dislocations, news citations, and epistemic leverage on Polymarket. arXiv:2609.06005 (2026). *Under review at ICWSM 2027.*
- [24] **Ibrahim, H.*** & Zaki, Y. Chance, persistent advantage, and the generative-AI era in open-source package careers. arXiv:2609.09687 (2026). *Under review at ICWSM 2027.*
- [25] **Ibrahim, H.*** & Zaki, Y. Understanding AI provider recommendations in local service markets. *Under review at The Web Conference (WWW) 2027.*
- [26] **Ibrahim, H.***, Rahwan, T. & Zaki, Y. Bias at the borderline: who gets the benefit of the doubt in peer review? arXiv:2607.26280 (2026). *Preprint.*

In Preparation

- [27] **Ibrahim, H.**, Liu, F., Zaki, Y. & Rahwan, T. Two-thirds of citations to review papers are closer to original research than to the review. *In preparation.*
- [28] **Ibrahim, H.**, Holovatska, Y., Aldahoul, N., Zaki, Y. & Rahwan, T. Manufactured participation in the Russia–Ukraine information war is industrial in supply but weak in demand. *In preparation.*
- [29] **Ibrahim, H.***, et al. Recomposition of early-career scientific credit in the generative AI era. *In preparation.*
- [30] **Ibrahim, H.***, et al. Multilingual under-enforcement in deployed content moderation. *In preparation.*
- [31] **Ibrahim, H.***, et al. A forensic analysis of the first deployed algorithmic bias-disclosure mandate. *In preparation.*
- [32] **Ibrahim, H.***, et al. Skewed enough to flip: how LLM annotator error reverses cross-language conclusions. *In preparation.*
- [33] **Ibrahim, H.***, et al. Congressional offices buy AI after losing staff, not before. *In preparation.*
- [34] **Ibrahim, H.***, et al. Asymmetric behavioural re-engagement after gains and losses on Polymarket. *In preparation.*

TEACHING

New York University Abu Dhabi

Instructor

2021–2022	Machine Learning (CS-UH 2220) — Spring 2022
2021–2022	Computational Social Science (CS-UH 2219E) — Spring 2021, Fall 2021
2021–2022	Database Systems (CS-UH 2214) — Fall 2021, Spring 2022
2021–2022	Data Structures (CS-UH 1050) — Spring 2021, Fall 2021

2020–2022 Discrete Mathematics (CS-UH 1002) — Fall 2021, Spring 2022, Summer 2022
2020–2022 Introduction to Computer Science (CS-UH 1001) — Fall 2020, Summer 2021, Fall 2021

University of Toronto

Teaching Assistant

2018–2019 Introduction to Computer Science (CSC148H) — Fall 2018, Spring 2018, Fall 2019

ACADEMIC ADVISING

Undergraduate Students Supervised

2026 Yana Holovatska, NYU Abu Dhabi
2026 Tewoflos Girmay, NYU Abu Dhabi
2025 Farhan Kamrul Khan, NYU Abu Dhabi
2025 Chen Wei Kuo, NYU Abu Dhabi
2025 Kevin Chu, NYU Abu Dhabi

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer *PNAS Nexus*, *AAAI ICWSM*, *IC2S2*, *ACM The Web Conference (WWW)*, *ACM CHI*, *ACM CSCW*, *Scientometrics*

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

2017 Software Engineering Intern, Meta, London, United Kingdom

SELECTED MEDIA COVERAGE

2026 **The Guardian:** TikTok’s algorithm favored Republican content in 2024 US elections [1]
2026 **Nature:** TikTok’s algorithm systematically skewed to the right during the 2024 US elections [1]
2026 **El País:** TikTok helped Trump win the 2024 election [1]
2026 **Phys.org:** TikTok algorithm shows pro-Republican bias [1]
2025 **PsyPost:** TikTok’s algorithm exhibited pro-Republican bias during 2024 presidential race, study finds [1]
2025 **United Nations:** Human Development Report 2025 – A matter of choice: People and possibilities in the age of AI [10]
2024 **Nature:** The citation black market: schemes selling fake references alarm scientists [5]
2024 **Science:** Vendor offering citations for purchase is latest bad actor in scholarly publishing [5]
2023 **Scientific American:** ChatGPT can get good grades. What should educators do about it? [10]
2023 **The Times:** Students “double cheat” to hide AI in their answers [10]
2023 **New Scientist:** ChatGPT gets better marks than students in some university courses [10]

- 2023 **The Independent:** AI can write better university assignments than students [10]
- 2023 **The Daily Beast:** OpenAI's ChatGPT surpasses college students in writing homework [10]
- 2023 **Daily Mail:** AI can achieve better grades than university students [10]
- 2023 **The National:** AI models 'achieve higher university grades than students' [10]
- 2023 **Nature Middle East:** ChatGPT sparks debate among students and educators [10]
- 2023 **Nature Asia:** ChatGPT's answers to essay questions can surpass those of university students [10]
- 2023 **Neuroscience News:** Can ChatGPT rival university students in academic performance? [10]
- 2023 **PsyPost:** YouTube's recommendation system exhibits left-leaning bias, new study suggests [8]

Additional coverage in *The Telegraph*, *The Herald Sun*, *Breitbart News*, *Truthout*, *DerStandard*, *Government Technology*, *Phys.org*, *American Council on Science and Health*, and *Daily Caller*.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.